



NSW Education Standards Authority

2024 HIGHER SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION

Drama

**General
Instructions**

- Reading time – 5 minutes
- Working time – 1 hour and 30 minutes
- Write using black pen

**Total marks:
40****Section I – 20 marks** (page 2)

- Attempt Question 1
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Section II – 20 marks (pages 3–6)

- Attempt ONE question from Questions 2–8
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Section I — Australian Drama and Theatre (Core Study)

20 marks

Attempt Question 1

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Answer the question on pages 2–8 of the Drama Writing Booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate knowledge and understanding of drama and theatre relevant to the question
 - express your point of view using appropriate supporting evidence
 - present a sustained, logical and cohesive response
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Question 1 (20 marks)

How does the space in which a play is staged influence its meaning?

In your response, refer to key dramatic moments from the TWO plays you have studied and your own experiential learning.

Topic 1: Dramatic Traditions in Australia

Texts set for study:

- Alexander Buzo, *Norm and Ahmed*
- Jack Davis, *No Sugar*
- Dorothy Hewett, *The Chapel Perilous*
- David Williamson, *The Removalists*

OR

Topic 2: Contemporary Australian Theatre Practice

Texts set for study:

- Jane Harrison, *Stolen*
- Lally Katz, *Neighbourhood Watch*
- Daniel Keene, *Life Without Me*
- Mirra Todd, *Fearless*

Section II — Studies in Drama and Theatre

20 marks

Attempt ONE question from Questions 2–8

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Answer the question on pages 10–16 of the Drama Writing Booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate knowledge and understanding of drama and theatre relevant to the question
 - express your point of view using appropriate supporting evidence
 - present a sustained, logical and cohesive response
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Question 2 — The Voice of Women in Theatre (20 marks)

How do directors give theatrical voice to issues affecting women's equality?

In your response, compare the TWO plays you have studied and refer to your own experiential learning on this topic.

Texts set for study:

List 1

- Caryl Churchill, *Top Girls*

or

- Aphra Behn et al., *The Rover in Restoration Comedy*

AND

List 2

- Donna Abela, *Jump for Jordan*

or

- Mary Anne Butler, *Highway of Lost Hearts*

or

- Joanna Murray-Smith, *The Female of the Species*

or

- Leah Purcell and Scott Rankin, *Box the Pony*

OR

Question 3 — Approaches to Acting (20 marks)

How is the staging of theatre works a manifestation of approaches to actor training?

In your response, refer to the TWO practitioners you have studied and your own experiential learning of this topic.

Practitioners and texts set for study:

- Augusto Boal, *Games for Actors and Non-Actors*
- Jacques Lecoq et al., *The Moving Body*
- Jonathan Pitches, *Vsevolod Meyerhold*
- James Slowiak and Jairo Cuesta, *Jerzy Grotowski*

OR

Question 4 — Verbatim Theatre (20 marks)

How do theatre makers maintain the balance between truth and audience engagement?

In your response, refer to the TWO plays you have studied and your own experiential learning of this topic.

Texts set for study:

- Campion Decent, *Embers*
- Tom Holloway, *Beyond the Neck: A Quartet on Loss and Violence*
- Robin Soans, *Talking to Terrorists*
- Alana Valentine, *Parramatta Girls*

OR

Question 5 — Black Comedy (20 marks)

How do directors explore the relationship between comedy and controversy?

In your response, refer to the TWO plays you have studied and your own experiential learning of this topic.

Texts set for study:

- Neil LaBute, *The Shape of Things*
- Martin McDonagh, *The Lieutenant of Inishmore*
- Harold Pinter, *The Homecoming*
- Ian Wilding, *October*

OR

Question 6 — Multi-Discipline Theatre (20 marks)

How do practitioners use collaborative processes to create highly visual forms?

In your response, refer to ONE practitioner in this topic and an original piece of Multi-Discipline Theatre.

Practitioners and texts set for study:

- Robert Lepage and ExMachina

Texts set for study:

- Patrick Caux et al., *Ex Machina: Creating for the Stage*
- Aleksandar Saša Dundjerović, *Robert Lepage*

or

- Simon McBurney and Théâtre de Complicité

Texts set for study:

- Complicite (Theatre company) and Simon McBurney (eds), *A Disappearing Number*
- Sarah Ainslie et al., *Complicite: Rehearsal Notes*

OR

Question 7 — Significant Plays of the 20th Century (20 marks)

How have revolutionary theatrical forms been used to create dynamic audience experiences?

In your response, refer to the TWO plays you have studied and your own experiential learning of this topic.

Texts set for study:

- Bertolt Brecht, *Mother Courage*
- Eugène Ionesco and Donald Watson (trans.), *The Bald Prima Donna: A Pseudo-Play in One Act*
- Moisés Kaufman, *The Laramie Project*
- Tony Kushner, *Angels in America: A Gay Fantasia on National Themes (Part 1)*

OR

Question 8 — Japanese Traditional and Contemporary Theatre (20 marks)

How do directors give expression to a theatrical aesthetic that is uniquely Japanese?

In your response, refer to your study of ONE traditional form, ONE contemporary work and your own experiential learning of this topic.

Texts set for study:

ONE of the following traditional Japanese forms:

- James R Brandon (ed.), *Kabuki: Five Classic Plays*
- Ernest Francisco Fenollosa et al., *The Noh Theatre of Japan: With Complete Texts of 15 Classic Plays*
- Stanleigh H Jones et al. (eds), *The Mountains from Mount Imo and Mount Se: Precepts for Women in The Bunraku Puppet Theatre of Japan: Honor, Vengeance, and Love in Four Plays of the 18th and 19th Centuries*

AND ONE of the following contemporary works of Tadashi Suzuki:

- Tadashi Suzuki, *The Way of Acting: The Theatre Writings of Tadashi Suzuki*

or

- Paul Allain, *The Art of Stillness: The Theatre Practice of Tadashi Suzuki*

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